

Second Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

1962 TLM: the invitation tested by charity in deed and truth

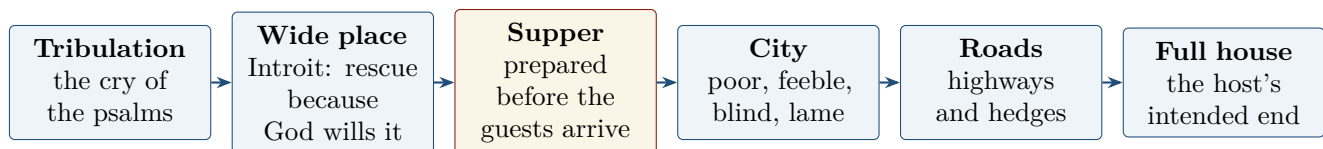
Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17:19-20)	Rescue into breadth	The Lord protects, saves, and brings the worshipper into a wide place because he wills him.
Collect	Perpetual fear and love of the holy Name	Reverence and stable love	God does not abandon those whom he establishes in the solidity of his love.
Epistle	1 John 3:13-18	From death to life; deed and truth	Christ's self-gift becomes the measure of material mercy toward the needy brother.
Gradual	<i>Ad Dominum, cum tribularer, clamavi</i> (Ps. 119:1-2)	Truthful speech	The cry for deliverance from lying lips prepares the hearer to recognize excuses as disordered speech.
Alleluia	<i>Domine Deus meus, in te speravi</i> (Ps. 7:2)	Hope under persecution	Hope asks God for the rescue promised in the Introit amid the world's hatred of the brethren.
Gospel	Luke 14:16-24	The great supper	Excuses disclose resistance; the invitation reaches the poor and then the roads and hedges.
Offertory	<i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6:5)	The Lord's return and rescue	The imperative addresses God: return, O Lord, deliver my soul, and save me for your mercy's sake.
Communion	<i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12:6)	Thanksgiving for benefits	The communicant sings because the supper and every good are first received as gift.
Postcommunion	<i>Sumptis muneribus sacris</i>	Growth in salvation	Frequent participation in the mystery is asked to increase salvation's effect.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	At a Pharisee's table, Jesus tells of invited guests who refuse a prepared supper; the householder then brings in the poor, feeble, blind, and lame and sends his servant farther out until the house is filled.
Allegorical	Augustine reads the host as Christ and the prepared supper as Christ's saving gift proclaimed by the apostles; in the Mass, the parable also examines readiness for Eucharistic communion.
Moral	First John tests the response to invitation: one passes from death to life by brotherly love, opens material goods to the needy, and loves in deed and truth rather than by an excuse-making tongue.
Anagogical	The supper points toward the heavenly banquet; the Secret asks for conduct transferred toward heavenly life, and the Postcommunion asks that sacramental participation increase salvation's effect.

From the Wide Place to the Full House

The Introit and Gospel share a spatial grammar. The Lord first brings the endangered worshipper into a "wide place" (*latitudo*); the host then sends the invitation outward until his house is full. Grace creates room before it asks the rescued person to make room for another.



Luke places the parable immediately after "Blessed is he that shall eat bread in the kingdom of God" (Luke 14:15), while Jesus is himself dining in a Pharisee's house. The setting makes the table simultaneously gift, judgment, and promise.

Who acts first? Divine agency across the Mass

The Lord protects, saves, and brings into breadth in the Introit; the Collect asks him to govern and establish the faithful in love; the Gospel's host prepares and repeatedly sends; the Alleluia hopes in God for rescue amid the world's hatred named by the Epistle. At the altar the Offertory asks the Lord to return, the Secret asks the oblation to purify and redirect conduct, Communion sings to the giver of good things, and the Postcommunion asks that salvation's effect increase. Response is real, but it is enclosed within prior and continuing gift.

The Trial of Speech

Before the Gospel presents three courteous refusals, the chants and Epistle have already taught the reader to test speech by truth and action.

Moment	Words heard	Kind of speech	Liturgical work
Gradual	Deliver me from lying lips and a deceitful tongue.	Speech that conceals or distorts reality.	The cry exposes the problem before the excuses are heard.
Epistle	Love not in word or tongue, but in deed and truth.	Speech severed from costly action.	The needy brother becomes the concrete test of an invisible claim.
Gospel	Farm, oxen, and marriage each produce a verbal refusal.	Plausible reasons that protect a disordered priority.	The invitation reveals what apparently lawful speech is serving.
Offertory	<i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam.</i>	A truthful plea addressed to God.	Excuse gives way to dependence: return, deliver, save for mercy's sake.
Communion	I will sing to the Lord who has bestowed good things on me.	Gratitude answering gift.	The mouth formerly under examination becomes capable of praise.

The Alleluia keeps this conversion of speech from becoming a self-improvement exercise: “In you have I hoped; save me.” Its trust answers both the Gradual’s tribulation and the Epistle’s warning that the world may hate the brethren.

Three Excuses, Three Disorders

Augustine’s Sermon 62.2–7 treats the excuses allegorically. The literal goods remain good; his concern is what happens when a finite good is made strong enough to defeat the summons.

Literal good	Augustine’s lens	The distortion	First John’s corrective
Farm or estate	Domination and the pride of possession.	Stewardship contracts into mastery: what is owned begins to own the owner.	Open worldly goods when a brother is in need.
Five yoke of oxen	Attachment to knowledge confined to the five bodily senses.	Only what can be inspected or proved on one’s own terms is allowed to command assent.	Know the passage from death to life by the reality of brotherly love.
Marriage	Fleshly attachment when pleasure becomes ultimate.	A true human bond is treated as a reason why God’s invitation cannot claim the whole person.	Measure love by Christ, who laid down his life for us.

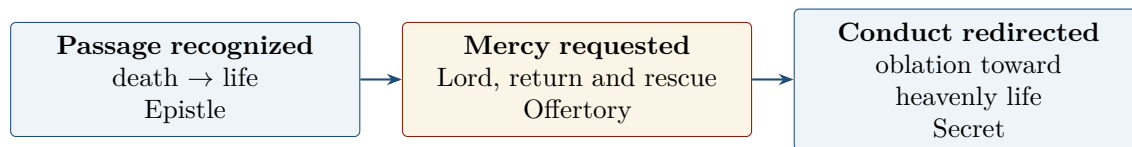
Guardrail: the goods are not the sins

Neither the parable nor Augustine’s allegory condemns property, work, bodily knowledge, or marriage as such. Each excuse is alarming precisely because a genuine good can be used to conceal a false order of love. The question is not whether the guest possesses a good, but whether the good has become a standing refusal of the giver.

Three Verbs of Passage

The Epistle, Offertory, and Secret form a precise verbal bridge. Keeping their grammar distinct prevents grace from being reduced to self-rescue.

Form	Grammar and direction	Place in the transformation
<i>translati sumus</i>	“We have passed / been transferred” from death to life (1 John 3:14).	The Epistle identifies brotherly love as evidence of a passage already effected, not as a slogan about benevolence.
<i>Domine, convertere</i>	A direct imperative to the Lord: “Return / turn, O Lord.”	The Offertory asks God to come to the soul’s aid and rescue it for his mercy’s sake; it does not tell the soul to convert itself.
<i>transferat</i>	The Secret asks that the dedicated oblation purify the offerers and transfer or redirect their conduct toward heavenly life.	The passage proclaimed by the Epistle enters sacramental petition and daily conduct at the altar.



Augustine at the Threshold

The heart prepared for the supper

In Sermon 62.5 Augustine identifies Christ as host and spiritual food, then says: “Do not get your mouth ready, but your heart.” The Eucharistic resonance arises from the parable’s place within this Mass: bodily attendance alone does not settle the question of interior welcome.

Charity’s serious beginning

Commenting on 1 John 3, Augustine gives a measured ascent rather than an abstraction: “If you are not yet equal to the dying for your brother, be even now equal to the giving of your means to your brother” (Homily 5 on First John, 12). Material mercy is not charity’s ceiling, but it is an immediate test of whether “deed and truth” have begun.

Questions to carry into Mass

- Where does the movement from “wide place” to “full house” reveal God’s initiative?
- How do the Gradual, Epistle, Gospel, Offertory, and Communion successively retrain the tongue?
- How does each of the three excuses use a real good to protect a false priority?
- Who is asked to turn in *Domine, convertere*, and what is asked to be transferred in the Secret?
- What increase does the Postcommunion seek from repeated participation in the sacred mystery?

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* 1962, *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*; local OCR corpus identified in the README. Psalm numbering follows the missal's Vulgate numbering.
- St. Augustine, Homily 5 on the First Epistle of John, especially sections 10–12: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/170205.htm>.
- St. Augustine, Sermon 62 on Luke 14:16–24, especially sections 1–7: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/160362.htm>.